

Sunday, 27 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

22° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

18° 13°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

18° 12°

GLASGOW

Rain

15° 11°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- Prince Harry has said it's 'great' to be back in Britain after six years living in the United States.**
He mentioned his children are "happy in school" and that the family returned to the UK for "lots of reasons". It's his first significant visit in a while.
ROYALS · UK

- Prime Minister Andy Burnham has announced a new scheme designed to help first-time buyers get onto the housing ladder.**
Mr Burnham stated he wants to support people who don't have financial help from the "bank of mum and dad". This initiative aims to address a key challenge for many aspiring homeowners.
POLITICS · UK

- A popular celebrity haunt in Mayfair has temporarily closed its doors as the Metropolitan Police investigate a claim involving a weapon.**
Maison Estelle, known for its high-profile clientele, has also had its alcohol licence suspended. The investigation is ongoing.
CRIME · UK

- A memorial is being held for pupils who were tragically contaminated with HIV and hepatitis during the 1970s and 80s.**
These children received medical treatments using contaminated blood products, a scandal that has affected many families. The memorial seeks to honour their lives.
HEALTH · UK

- Thousands of electric motorbikes seized by police across the UK are being sold on at auction, a BBC investigation has revealed.**
These bikes are often confiscated because they're suspected of being driven illegally or used in crimes. While most are destroyed, at least 161 were sold last year.
CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The Booker Prize judges have revealed their shortlist for this year's prestigious literary award after what they described as a 'tussle'.**

Past Booker winners Marlon James and Douglas Stuart are among the nominees, making for a very strong field. We'll find out the winner later this year.

ON AIR – Have you read any of the shortlisted books, or do you have a favourite author you'd love to see win?

AWARDS · AUTUMN
- 2 Burberry closed London Fashion Week 2026 with its signature check print and a front row packed with celebrities.**

The event marked the culmination of a week showcasing the biggest trends for the upcoming season. It's always a highlight on the fashion calendar.

ON AIR – Did you follow London Fashion Week? What fashion trends are you most excited about for next year?

FASHION · NEXT YEAR
- 3 Catherine Zeta-Jones is basing her new role as a former cocaine dealer on funny Welsh people she knows.**

She plays Jackie Price in the upcoming film 'Kill Jackie', a character targeted by assassins. It sounds like she's bringing a unique flavour to the role.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Catherine Zeta-Jones performance, or are you looking forward to seeing her in this new film?

FILM · SOON
- 4 American rapper Macklemore has announced a 'Free Palestine' tour, with proceeds going to organisations supporting Palestinians.**

The tour is set to begin in Dublin next month. This follows some recent controversy involving Ed Sheeran.

ON AIR – Macklemore is known for his socially conscious lyrics. What do you think about artists using their platform for political causes?

MUSIC · NEXT MONTH
- 5 An Indian film from Nagaland, 'Angh', is now on a path towards the Oscars after a major win at the Toronto Film Festival.**

The film brings a rarely seen world to global cinema, offering a unique cultural perspective. It's exciting to see new voices gain international recognition.

ON AIR – Do you enjoy discovering films from different parts of the world, or do you tend to stick to more mainstream cinema?

FILM · AWARDS

On the schedule

1 **George Russell has described his Azerbaijan Grand Prix win as “the most dominant weekend I’ve had in my career”.**

He said it felt like vindication after a “real tough period”. Russell is clearly on top form, earning him the nickname 'Mr Saturday'.

ON AIR – What a performance from Russell! Do you think he's got what it takes to challenge for the championship this season?

F1 · INTERNATIONAL

2 **England’s Red Roses have extended their unbeaten run to 41 Tests with a dramatic last-gasp try against New Zealand.**

Zoe Harrison scored in overtime to secure a 26-19 victory at the Allianz Stadium. What a way to win!

ON AIR – Incredible drama! Do you think the Red Roses are currently the most dominant team in British sport?

RUGBY · UK

3 **Gloucester produced an outstanding display to shock last season’s runners-up Exeter Chiefs with a superb victory.**

They scored seven tries, winning 45-24, proving they are a force to be reckoned with. It was a fantastic performance.

ON AIR – What a result for Gloucester! Did you expect them to pull off such a dominant win against Exeter?

RUGBY · UK

4 **Tyson Fury says his long-awaited all-British heavyweight fight against Anthony Joshua in December is now in jeopardy.**

Fury claims the fight is at risk due to a promoter row. Fans have been eagerly anticipating this bout for a long time.

ON AIR – Oh no, not again! Do you think this fight will ever actually happen, or are we destined to just keep waiting?

BOXING · UK

5 **Northern Ireland secured a dramatic Nations League victory over Georgia with a 99th-minute winner from Shea Charles.**

It was a truly late finish, with Charles scoring deep into injury time to snatch the win. What a moment for the fans!

ON AIR – Talk about a nail-biter! Do you think Northern Ireland can build on this momentum in the Nations League?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees communities rediscovering the joy of 'public pianos' in parks and train stations.**
These accessible instruments are encouraging impromptu singalongs and fostering unexpected connections among strangers, bringing a touch of musical magic to everyday spaces.
- 2 The simple pleasure of 'homemade preserves' is experiencing a delightful resurgence.**
More people are turning their hand to making jams, chutneys, and pickles, not just for the taste but for the satisfying feeling of creating something delicious from scratch.
- 3 Researchers are highlighting the benefits of 'nature journaling' for mental well-being.**
Taking time to sketch and write observations about the natural world around us, no matter how small, can reduce stress and increase mindfulness.
- 4 The delightful art of 'crafting personalised greetings cards' is seeing a creative boom.**
People are finding joy in designing unique cards for loved ones, adding a truly personal touch that stands out from shop-bought alternatives.
- 5 The charming tradition of 'community garden exchanges' is flourishing in neighbourhoods.**
Gardeners are sharing their surplus produce, seeds, and gardening tips, creating a lovely sense of camaraderie and reducing waste.
- 6 Experts suggest that 'learning a new magic trick' can boost confidence and dexterity.**
Mastering a simple illusion offers a fun challenge and provides a delightful way to entertain friends and family.
- 7 The calming pastime of 'collecting quirky pebbles' from beaches and rivers is gaining fans.**
It's a wonderful way to connect with nature and appreciate the unique artistry of the natural world, turning a walk into a treasure hunt.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new box set, especially if it's a long series. What is it?
- ANSWER:** REARRANGING THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA 'JUST SO' FOR OPTIMAL COMFORT.

- Q** Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of shampoo will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?
- ANSWER:** GIVING IT A LITTLE SNIFF, EVEN THROUGH THE BOTTLE, FOR THAT 'FRESH' FEELING.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of cloud formation' just instantly makes you stop and stare, perhaps because of its dramatic shape or beautiful colours?
What's the most unusual or breathtaking cloud formation you've ever seen, and where were you when you spotted it?
- We all have that 'one small, everyday household chore' that, despite its mundane nature, you actually find quite satisfying to complete, don't we?
What's that one chore for you that surprisingly brings a sense of accomplishment, and why do you enjoy it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that sloths are so slow that algae can grow on their fur, helping them to camouflage themselves in the trees?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that some types of butterflies migrate such long distances that they can actually hibernate for a month during their journey, only to wake up and continue flying?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of ferrets is delightfully called a 'business'.
- The world's first ever text message, sent in 1992, simply said 'Merry Christmas'.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is often considered the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- The humble teabag was accidentally invented in 1908 by a New York tea merchant who sent samples in silk bags.
- The sound of crickets chirping can actually be used to estimate the air temperature; count the chirps in 15 seconds and add 37 for an approximate Fahrenheit temperature.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar sources.
- The 'Wobbly Bridge' in London, officially the Millennium Bridge, swayed unexpectedly on its opening day in 2000 due to synchronised footsteps.

On this day

Day 270 of the year, 95 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Adheritus; Christian feast days: Bonfilius; Christian feast days: Caius of Milan; Christian feast days: Hiltrude of Liessies. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1987 — Austin Carlile, American singer-songwriter
- 1958 — Irvine Welsh, Scottish author and playwright
- 1992 — Sam Lerner, American actor
- 1936 — Gordon Honeycombe, English actor, playwright, and author (died 2015)
- 1982 — Jon McLaughlin, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1948 — A Martinez, American actor
- 1982 — Lil Wayne, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1956 — Martin Handford, English children's author and illustrator

THE DAY TODAY

- 2003 — The SMART-1 satellite is launched.
- 2019 — Over two million people participated in worldwide strikes to protest climate change across 2,400 locations worldwide.
- 1988 — The National League for Democracy is formed by Aung San Suu Kyi and others to fight dictatorship in Myanmar.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1949 — Zeng Liansong's design is chosen as the flag of the People's Republic of China.
- 1975 — The last use of capital punishment in Spain sparks worldwide protests.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1944 — World War II: The Kassel Mission results in the largest loss by a USAAF group on any mission during the war.
- 2008 — CNSA astronaut Zhai Zhigang becomes the first Chinese person to perform a spacewalk.
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1941 — World War II: The Greek National Liberation Front is established with Georgios Siantos as acting leader.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 271 of the year, 94 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron of Auxerre; Christian feast day: Amalia Abad Casasempere; Christian feast day: Annemund; Christian feast day: Chariton the Confessor. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1981 — Jerrika Hinton, American actress
- 1987 — Gary Deegan, Irish footballer
- 1967 — Mira Sorvino, American actress
- 2000 — Frankie Jonas, American actor, singer, and songwriter
- 1975 — Isamu Jordan, American journalist and academic (died 2013)
- 1938 — Ben E. King, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 2015)
- 1935 — Ronald Lacey, English actor (died 1991)
- 1981 — Greg Anderson, American pianist and composer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1958 — Fernando Rios, a Mexican tour guide in New Orleans, dies of injuries sustained in an incident of gay bashing.
- 1983 — John Pat, a 16-year old Aboriginal Australian boy, dies of injuries sustained by four off-duty police officers in Roebourne, a catalyst to the Royal Commission into Aboriginal Deaths in Custody.
- 2012 — Sita Air Flight 601 crashes in Madhyapur Thimi, Nepal, killing all 19 passengers and crew.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1994 — The cruise ferry MS Estonia sinks in the Baltic Sea, killing 852 people.
- 1995 — Bob Denard and a group of mercenaries take the islands of the Comoros in a coup.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar